

CASE STUDY- QR CODE SCAMS

UPI or Online Payment Fraud is a kind of theft that happens on the internet. This is where Scammers take advantage of the fact that the Unified Payments Interface's really fast. They use this to steal money from peoples accounts. This is not like the hacking. Instead these Scammers trick the victim into doing something that helps them steal the money.

How it Happens: Step-by-Step

1. In a scam that uses a QR Code the Scammer finds someone who is selling something on the internet like on OLX or Facebook Marketplace.
2. The Scammer contacts the seller. Says they really want to buy the item. They agree to pay the price right away so the seller trusts them.
3. Then the Scammer sends a QR code to the seller on WhatsApp. They say this is for the payment. They tell the seller to scan the code to get the money.
4. When the seller scans the code their UPI app asks them to enter their UPI PIN. The Scammer tells them to hurry up saying the link will expire soon.
5. When the seller enters their PIN they are not getting money. They are actually allowing the Scammer to take money from their account. The money goes to the persons account right away.

WHO IT HAPPENS TO AND HOW MUCH?

The people who usually get targeted by these scams are those who sell things on the internet old people who may not know much about payments and students who are looking for part-time jobs or good deals. Recently from 2025 to 2026 it seems like the Scammers are also targeting people who live in areas and small business owners who are starting to use digital payments.

What happens to the people who get scammed is that they lose a lot of money as much as ₹10,000 to, over ₹1 lakh and it all happens in just a few seconds.

They can report this to the National Cyber Crime Helpline, (which is 1930) but it is hard to get the money back especially if the Scammers have already moved it to many different accounts.

The people who get scammed also feel a lot of stress. They start to not trust digital systems, which can make it hard for them to use the internet for money things.